CHAPTER 4

CAUSE / EFFECT ESSAYS

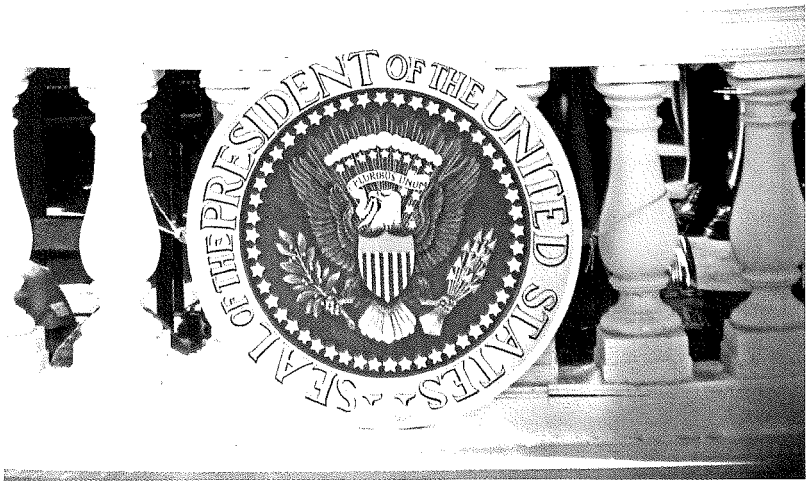
OBJECTIVES

To write academic texts, you need to master certain skills.

In this chapter, you will learn to:

- Analyze two cause / effect essays
- Distinguish between cause and effect
- Plan an essay using chain or block organization
- Recognize and use parallel structures to create symmetry
- Incorporate quotations, statistics, and examples to support claims
- Write, revise, and edit an essay about a historical event





John F. Kennedy: an Irish-American president of the United States of America.

INTRODUCTION

Much of your thinking each day naturally focuses on analyzing events: you want to understand why something happened. Why, for example, do you have a sore throat? Why does your car not start? Likewise, you want to understand the results of some action or event. If you take some medicine, will it cure your sore throat? If you charge the battery, will the car start? These are the functions of causal analysis, which examines causes and effects.

A *cause* is a reason something happened or is happening, while an *effect* is the change that results from something happening. In academic and professional pursuits, cause / effect generally applies to examinations of social behavior, scientific investigation, and the study of historical events. A **cause / effect essay** is one that explores the causes and/or effects of an action, an event, or a series of occurrences. Many such things, however, have more than one cause or effect. For example, a virus may have caused that sore throat, but lack of sleep and too much stress may have lowered the resistance to the virus. Additionally, you cannot always be sure what causes something, nor can you predict with certainty what effects may result. In discussing causes or effects, therefore, you may use qualifying words such as *probable, possible,* and *likely*. You might also qualify your claims with data that show percentages, ratios, or trends. Although cause / effect analysis can apply to any subject matter, this chapter will focus on cause / effect analysis as it relates to history.

ANALYZING THE MODELS

The model essays explore a number of causes that led to a final result or effect. The first essay traces a series of causes, in which one leads to another. The second examines a group of effects occurring at approximately the same time.

Read the models. Then answer the questions.

Writing Model 1

THE IRISH POTATO FAMINE

1 Throughout much of its history, the United States has welcomed immigrants to its shores. People have come because of opportunity, political liberty, and religious freedom. Others have come because of oppression and poverty in their native countries. There is no greater example of the latter reason for immigration than the Irish who fled to this country during the Great Potato Famine of 1845 through 1851. They came because of their failed crops and their resulting starvation, the loss of their homes and possessions to their indifferent landlords, and the ineffectiveness of the English and Irish governments to help them survive.

2 The conditions under which the majority of the eight million Irish lived were shocking. "There never was," the Duke of Wellington wrote, "a country in which poverty existed to the extent it exists in Ireland." A census in 1841 reported, "Nearly half of the rural population is living

(continued on next page)

in the lowest state." People were crammed inside one-room mud cabins without windows or furniture. Farmers slept with their pigs in filthy conditions. Homeless people put roofs over ditches or slept in tunnels they dug in the ground (Woodham-Smith 20).

3 All this misery could be traced to absentee[1] English and wealthy Irish landlords. An 1845 report stated that their property was merely "a source from which to extract as much money as possible." Landlords leased their land to others who divided it so they could collect more rent. The Irish tenants paid for the right to farm it and to put a cabin up on the property quickly. No money was exchanged, however. The payments were measured by the number of days the tenants worked (Woodham-Smith 20–21).

4 This arrangement depended "entirely and exclusively," on the potato (Woodham-Smith 35). It grew easily in the bad soil and was easy to cook. The potato was also perfect for feeding pigs, cattle, and chickens. The crop, however, would rot soon after harvesting and could not be stored between growing seasons (Woodham-Smith 35–36). By 1840, one-third of the Irish population depended entirely on the potato for food. It was, "a dependency that teetered[2] on the brink of starvation and created a time bomb that needed only the slightest spark to explode".

5 That spark exploded in 1845 when the potato crop was attacked by a fungus[3]. The leaseholders dug the potatoes up, only to find that they had turned into "a dark, gooey mess" (*The Great Hunger*). Six months later, the famine began. It continued and grew worse virtually every year until 1850.

6 At first, the British government tried to help by importing Indian corn from the United States. However, the corn made many people ill, and most tenants had to sell or pawn[4] all their possessions to pay for it. Then the government initiated a second plan: hiring the farm laborers to build roads and canals. By December of 1846, half a million men were breaking rocks up into pieces and shoveling dirt. At this point, however, some workers died of starvation before receiving their wages (Bloy).

7 The famine worsened in 1846 when disease struck the potato crop again. "A stranger," wrote a sub-inspector of police from County Cork, "would wonder how these wretched[5] beings find food. . . . They sleep in their rags and have pawned their bedding" (Woodham-Smith 92). Unfortunately, much of the food they found was the seed potatoes for next year's crop. As a result, when the 1847 harvest came in free of disease, it was too small to feed everyone. In 1848, the situation worsened as the blight[6] came back, destroying the entire crop.

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[1] **absentee:** someone who lives a long way away from the property he or she rents to others
[2] **teetered:** stood or moved in an unsteady way as if going to fall
[3] **fungus:** a fast-growing mold
[4] **pawn:** leave something with another in exchange for borrowing money
[5] **wretched:** unhappy or poor
[6] **blight:** a plant disease in which parts of the plant dry up and die

8 By this time, even the landlords became desperate. They threw out half a million tenants who could not pay their rent through labor, and then burned their homes. Consequently, many went to live in poor houses. In 1847, however, all public work projects ended, and public poor houses were closed (*The Irish Famine*). Now with the tenants homeless and living in filth, typhoid fever, cholera[7], and dysentery[8] broke out, claiming more lives than starvation itself. An official estimate claimed that 750,000 people died from the famine and related causes, but the true number may have been twice as many (*Case-Studies*).



9 As a result, a million Irish poor fled the country, most of them heading by boat across the Atlantic. The conditions on these "coffin ships" were horrifying, and many people died during the journey. Of those who survived, the great majority went to Quebec and Montreal, Canada, but after arriving, over half walked across the border to the United States. They wanted no part of living in Canada, a British colony (Woodham-Smith 209).

10 The Irish viewed the rapidly growing United States as a land of opportunity. These poor immigrants showed up in rags, without money, education, or skill, but they had a small glimmer of hope[9]. Over the last nearly two centuries, that hope has been fully realized. The Irish population of the United States has more than doubled that of all of Ireland, and an Irish American was even elected to the most powerful position in the United States: John Fitzgerald Kennedy became the first Irish-American president in 1961.

Sources:

1. Bloy, Marjie. *The Irish Famine: 1845-9.*
2. Case-Studies: Irish potato famine (1845 to 1851).
3. Irish Potato Famine and Trade (History). Web. 10 May 1996.
4. Woodham-Smith, Cecil. *The Great Hunger.*

[7] **cholera:** a serious disease of the stomach and bowels caused by infected water or food

[8] **dysentery:** a serious disease of the bowels that leads to bleeding and passing more waste than normal

[9] **glimmer of hope:** a small sign of hope

(Questions on next page)

Questions about the Model

1. Which sentence in Paragraph 1 is the thesis statement of the essay? Underline it.
2. What important effect of the Irish potato famine does the concluding paragraph describe?
3. What chain of effects was created by the destruction of the potato crop over several years?
4. Which words or phrases signal or introduce each cause or effect? Circle them.
5. Why did the substitution of corn for potatoes fail?
6. Who does the author think is primarily responsible for the horrible conditions under which the Irish peasants lived? Why do you think so?

Writing Model 2

THE EXPLOSIVE GROWTH OF THE CITIES

By Mark C. Carnes and John A. Garraty

1 By the end of the nineteenth century, immigrants from southern and eastern Europe crowded into cities that were already heavily populated by native-born Americans. As a result, the cities suffered greatly from the effects of rapid growth. Sanitation, fire protection, and the paving of streets were inadequate. Housing was insufficient and overcrowded. Families fell apart, and crime grew out of control. Because of the extent of these problems, however, people eventually took steps to improve living conditions.

2 Sewer and water facilities could not keep pace with the rapidly increasing needs. By the 1890s, the tremendous growth of Chicago had put such a strain on the sanitation system that the Chicago River had become virtually an open sewer. The city's drinking water contained such a high concentration of germ-killing chemicals that it was almost undrinkable. In the 1880s, all the sewers of Baltimore emptied into the Back River Basin. According to the journalist H. L. Mencken, every summer smelled like "a billion polecats."[1] Fire protection became less and less adequate. Garbage piled up on the streets faster than workers could carry it away. The streets themselves crumbled beneath the pounding of heavy traffic. Urban growth proceeded with such speed that the cities laid out new streets much more rapidly than they could be paved. Chicago had more than 1,400 miles of dirt streets in 1890.

[1] **polecats:** skunks—small black and white animals that produce a very strong smell if they are attacked or afraid

3 The population explosion also placed a great strain on the housing supply. People poured into the great cities faster than houses and apartments could be built for them. As a result, the densely packed areas of the 1840s became unbearable. Greedy builders used every foot of space, squeezing out light and air in order to jam in a few additional family units.



4 Substandard living quarters aggravated[2] other evils such as the breakdown of family life, along with mental distress, crime, and juvenile delinquency.[3] The bloody New York riots of 1863, for example, were caused in part by the bitterness and frustration of thousands jammed together. A citizens' committee expressed amazement after visiting the slums "that so much misery, disease, and wretchedness can be huddled together and hidden."

5 Eventually, however, practical forces operated to bring about improvements. Once the relationship between polluted water and disease was fully understood, everyone saw the need for clean water and decent sewage systems. City dwellers of all classes resented the dirt, noise, and ugliness. In many communities, public-spirited groups formed societies to plant trees, clean up littered areas, and develop recreational facilities. When one city took on improvements, others tended to follow suit, prompted by local pride and competition between cities.

6 Gradually, the basic facilities of urban living were improved. Streets were paved, first with stones and wood blocks, and then with smoother, quieter asphalt. Gaslight, then electric arc lights, and finally Thomas Edison's incandescent lamps brightened the cities after dark. This illumination of the cities made law enforcement easier. It also stimulated nightlife and permitted factories and shops to operate after sunset. Life in the cities was far from ideal, but streetcars would take people quickly and inexpensively to work and back, and high-rise buildings would soon fill the horizons. The modern American city was forming throughout the East and Midwest.

Source: Adapted from Carnes, Mark C. and John A. Garraty. "American Society in the Industrial Age."

[2] **aggravated:** made a bad situation worse
[3] **delinquency:** illegal or unacceptable behavior, especially by young people

(Questions on next page)

Questions about the Model

1. According to the first paragraph, what led to the terrible living conditions of the cities? What was the final effect of these conditions?
2. What effects does the body of the essay focus on? How many are there?
3. What key effects are introduced in the final two paragraphs? Which sentences state them most directly? Underline them twice.
4. What specific measures were taken to address specific causes?
5. Quotations are included in both model essays. What purpose do they serve?

Noticing Vocabulary: Phrasal Verbs

The two writing models contain a number of **phrasal verbs**, which are special collocations. A phrasal verb combines a *verb* and one or two *particles* (short prepositions); together they have a meaning that is different from the verb alone. There are two types of phrasal verbs:

- A **separable phrasal verb** moves or changes the condition of its object. A noun object can come before or after the second word (the particle) of the phrasal verb.*

  The landlords *threw* ***the farmers*** *out*.

  The landlords *threw out* ***the farmers***.

  However, a pronoun object can come only before the particle.

  The landlords *threw* ***them*** *out*. (The verb moves the object.)

- An **inseparable phrasal verb** does not move or change the condition of the object. The object always follows the particle.

  Peasants *turned to* ***desperate measures***.

  Peasants *turned to* ***them***. (The object does not change or move.)

For more information about common separable and inseparable phrasal verbs, see Appendix D, page 206.

* Moving the noun object from one place to the other can also create an awkward sentence, especially when the particle ends the phrasal verb. For example: The cities *laid out* ***new roads*** (fine). The cities *laid* ***new roads*** *out* (awkward). Therefore, be careful in choosing the best word order.

PRACTICE 1 Noticing Phrasal Verbs

Look at the writing models again and find the phrasal verbs. Using the context, label them *S* (separable) or *I* (inseparable).

MODEL 1

_____ **1.** put up *(paragraph 3)*

_____ **2.** depend on *(paragraph 4)*

_____ **3.** dig up *(paragraph 5)*

_____ **4.** turn into *(paragraph 5)*

_____ **5.** break up *(paragraph 6)*

_____ **6.** come in *(paragraph 7)*

_____ **7.** come back *(paragraph 7)*

_____ **8.** show up *(paragraph 10)*

MODEL 2

_____ **9.** fall apart *(paragraph 1)*

_____ **10.** pile up *(paragraph 2)*

_____ **11.** bring about *(paragraph 5)*

_____ **12.** take on *(paragraph 5)*

ORGANIZATION

Writing a cause / effect essay requires that you gather information and plan carefully. In some cases, it begins with research, such as finding and analyzing the possible causes of a historical event. In others, it starts with experimentation, such as noting the effects of a change in diet on laboratory mice. No matter what the case, however, you must address these two questions in planning your essay:

- Who will be reading my paper, and how much do they know about the subject matter?
- Am I examining more than one cause or effect? Are the causes or effects occurring at the same time, or does one lead to another?

The answer to the last question will help you decide on the structure of your essay.

An event may have more than one cause, and a cause may have more than one effect. Sometimes the causes occur one after another; in other words, in chain reaction. Writing Model 1 follows this pattern in examining the causes of the immigration of Irish peasants to the United States. At other times, all the causes or all the effects occur at about the same time. Writing Model 2 follows this pattern as it examines the effects of overcrowding in the cities.

The structure of a cause / effect essay can be organized in one of two ways: with **chain** organization, in which you examine causes or effects in a sequence, or with **block** organization, in which you examine the multiple causes or effects of some action or situation. This organization is appropriate when all the causes or effects are not in a sequence.

CHAIN ORGANIZATION

A chain organization examines causes and effects that are directly linked sequentially. In other words, one cause leads to an effect, which leads to another cause, and so on.

A diagram of this type of organization pattern, with examples from Writing Model 1, looks like this:

Introductory Paragraph

The opening paragraph states the effect and outlines the chain of events.

Effect: Irish peasants immigrating to the United States, because of a series of causes related to the Great Potato Famine

Chain of Events: failed crops, resulting starvation, the loss of their homes and possessions, and ineffective government response

↓

First Group of Body Paragraphs

The first body paragraphs examine causes, usually in chronological order.

Paragraphs 2 and 3: the extreme poverty of the rural Irish and terrible conditions in which they lived, farming land that they did not own

Paragraph 4: the reliance of the Irish on potatoes and the subsequent effect when the crop failed

↓

Final Group of Body Paragraphs

The final body paragraphs detail a step-by-step description of the cause / effect chain as support

Paragraphs 5 through 9: loss of possessions, enlistment on poorly designed public works projects, eviction from their homes, poor houses, disease, desperation, and passage to Canada

↓

Concluding Paragraph

The final paragraph states the conclusive effect.

Paragraph 10: coming to the United States and integrating into American society

BLOCK ORGANIZATION

Block organization, the structure of the second writing model, examines the multiple causes (or effects) of some action or situation when the causes or effects are *not* directly linked sequentially. A diagram of block organization, with examples from Writing Model 2, looks like this:

Introductory Paragraph

The opening paragraph introduces the topic, makes clear why it is important, and then provides a transition into an analysis of the causes or effects.

Thesis: cities suffered as a result of too rapid growth

Transition: the problems caused by this overgrowth were so widespread, steps for improvement had to be taken

↓

Body Paragraphs

The body paragraphs examine or suggest one possible or probable cause or effect, and provide information, data, or interpretation as support.

Paragraph 2: inadequate sanitation, water facilities, and fire protection

Paragraph 3: housing supply shortage

Paragraph 4: disease and disintegration of family life

↓

Concluding Paragraph(s)

The final paragraphs summarize the causes or effects discussed in the body paragraphs, and then state the consequences.

Paragraph 5: actions to provide cleaner water, make government more responsive, plant trees and clean up the cities, and illuminate the streets

Types of Support

As with any type of writing, you must support the claims in the body paragraphs of your cause/effect essay. Look again at the body paragraphs of the models. Note that each claim is supported by a survey, a set of statistics, one or more examples, a specific description, an explanation, or a quotation. You are already familiar with most of these types of support. Chapter 1 introduced you to explanations and examples. Chapter 2 taught you about conducting surveys, and briefly introduced you to statistics. Chapter 3 taught you how to summarize. And later in this chapter, you will learn more about using quotations.

For writing guides to help you introduce cause and effect, see Appendix A on page 190.

PRACTICE 2 Analyzing Paragraph Support

Look at Writing Model 1 on pages 65–67. Choose three body paragraphs to analyze. Identify the types of support used in each (*surveys*, *statistics*, *examples*, *specific descriptions*, *explanations*, or *quotations*), and include a two-to-four-word description of the content.

EXAMPLE

Paragraph 2 Types of support: Quotation and statistics on number of beds and chairs

1. Paragraph _____ Types of support: _____

2. Paragraph _____ Types of support: _____

3. Paragraph _____ Types of support: _____

PRACTICE 3 Developing Paragraph Support

Underline the words or phrases that need to be explained or developed in each thesis statement. List examples of topics that might support the thesis.

1. The Thirteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution, which ended slavery in 1865, had enormous consequences.
   a. freedom for large numbers of people
   b. need for former slaves to find employment
   c. need for former slave owners to find ways to run their plantations

2. The invention of electricity led to dramatic changes in people's lives.
   a. _____
   b. _____
   c. _____

3. People immigrate to other countries for a number of reasons.
   a. _____
   b. _____
   c. _____
   d. _____

DISTINGUISHING BETWEEN CAUSE AND EFFECT

In order to ensure that your essay is clearly organized and flows logically, you should take care to avoid some of these potential problems with your analysis.

Confusing cause with effect

Although this may seem easy, separating cause from effect can be complicated. For example, was the poverty of the Irish peasants a *cause* of their starvation or an *effect* of their responding to the loss of the crops?

Confusing the sequence of events with their causes

If you woke up with a headache on a bright, sunny morning, did the sunshine cause your headache? If you were out in the rain and then developed a cold, did the rain cause the cold—or did lack of sleep, too much stress, or exposure to a virus cause it?

Oversimplifying complex causes and effects

Many effects have complex causes or possible causes; likewise, so do many causes have complex effects. Note that both model essays explore those complexities.

PRACTICE 4 **Identifying Causes or Effects**

Circle the cause and underline the effect in each statement.

1. Irish immigrants (having few skills other than farming) experienced great difficulty in finding a job in cities.
2. The rate of obesity in the United States has increased greatly in the past twenty years due to a number of factors.
3. The large increase in the number of Hispanics in the last twenty years has led to a number of significant changes in U.S. culture and society.
4. The emigration of Eastern Europeans in the beginning of the twentieth century was both an economic and a political necessity.
5. The Civil War in the United States was the result of a progressive series of events.
6. Global life expectancy has greatly increased thanks to improvements in sanitation and nutrition.

Transition Signals for Introducing Causes and Effects

As always, transition signals help establish unity and clarity in an essay. The list of expressions can help make the relationship between causes and effects clear.

Rules	Examples	
1. Use these transition signals to introduce *causes*.	a key factor because because of due to	one reason owing to since this occurred the first cause
2. Use these transition signals to introduce *effects*.	accordingly as a consequence as a result consequently	one outcome resulting in so the first effect
3. Use these transition signals to *qualify statements*.	could (have) may (have) might (have)	perhaps possibly probably

Short transition signals are valuable tools in a cause/effect essay. However, a clearly organized and gracefully written essay often benefits from whole sentences of transition.

For additional help using transitions, see Appendix B on page 200.

PRACTICE 5 **Adding Transitions**

Rewrite the passage, inserting transitions where needed.

People from all over the world immigrate to the United States. They search for better employment, or, for that matter, any job. Refugees from war and political oppression come here. People seek religious freedom or escape from persecution for their religious beliefs or practices. Other people wish to pursue a college education or post-graduate education at a university. A few happy people arrive in the country to marry an American citizen they have met abroad.

People from all over the world immigrate to the United States for a variety of reasons.

SENTENCE STRUCTURE

One way to improve the clarity of your sentences is to keep items in a series consistent in grammatical form. This consistency is referred to as **parallelism**, like parallel lines in mathematics.

USING PARALLELISM

Clarity and maturity of style are the marks of effective writing. Parallelism, also called **parallel structure**, repeats items in a series using the same grammatical form so your ideas are symmetrical and clear. Look at these examples from the writing models at the beginning of the chapter.

PARALLEL INFINITIVES In many communities, public-spirited groups formed societies **to plant** trees, **clean up** littered areas, and **develop** recreational facilities. (Note that the repetition of *to* is not necessary.)

PARALLEL NOUNS City dwellers of all classes resented the **dirt**, **noise**, and **ugliness**. These poor immigrants arrived in rags, **without money**, **education**, or **skill**, but they had a small glimmer of hope.

PARALLEL SENTENCES Fire protection **became** less and less adequate. Garbage **piled up** on the streets. The streets themselves **crumbled** beneath the pounding of heavy traffic. (sentences in the identical pattern)

PRACTICE 6 Identifying Parallel Structures

Underline the parallel structures in each passage.

1. They came because of their failed crops and their resulting starvation, the loss of their homes and possessions to their indifferent landlords, and the ineffectiveness of the English and Irish governments to help them survive.
2. Sanitation, fire protection, and the paving of streets were inadequate.
3. Substandard living quarters aggravated[1] other evils such as the breakdown of family life, along with mental distress, crime, and juvenile delinquency.
4. Residents of the city resented the crowds, smells, and pollution.
5. The city government began to build new housing, repair streets, and create public parks.
6. Streets were paved, first with stones and wood blocks, and then with smoother, quieter asphalt. Gaslights were used to brighten the cities after dark, which made law enforcement easier. Streetcars were introduced which took people quickly and inexpensively to work and back and cut back on traffic.

[1] **aggravated:** made a bad situation worse

PRACTICE 7 Writing Parallel Structures

Complete each sentence with words or phrases that repeat the grammatical form of the italicized words. Look at the writing models on pages 65–69 as needed.

1. The rural Irish were *uneducated,* poor, and hungry.
2. They *lived* in shacks, *shared living quarters,* and _____.
3. The potato served as food for the _____, _____, and _____.
4. The poor Irish became desperate, hoping *to find work,* _____, and _____.
5. The streets of the big cities in the U.S. were *dirty,* _____, and _____.
6. People began to *clean up* the cities, _____, and _____.

Writing Tip

One clue to identifying errors in parallelism is to circle every *and* in your first draft. The word *and* can join only structures that are grammatically equal. For example, "He is tall and thin," or "He is a husband and a father" are both logical. However, "He is tall and a father" is not!

PRACTICE 8 Correcting Errors in Parallelism

Correct the errors in parallelism. Write your correction above the line. The italicized words provide hints as to which structures that follow them may be incorrect.

Controversy over immigrants and the language they speak is not new. Millions of Germans *moved* to the United States in the 1800s and bringing their language with them. They not only held their religious services in German, but they also opened private schools in which the teachers *taught* in German, published German-language newspapers, and speaking German *at* home, in stores, and also spoke it in taverns. Eventually all this changed.

The first generation of immigrants spoke German almost exclusively. The second generation assimilated, *speaking* English at home, but also would speak German when they visited their parents. For the most part, the third

generation knew German only as "that language" that their grandparents used. Many other immigrants who came after the Germans have followed the same pattern: *the Japanese*, the Italians, Eastern Europeans, and there are many more.

PREPARATION FOR WRITING

The two writing models you read at the beginning of this chapter are based on research. Researching a topic can be interesting, even fun, once you know how to do it. The information you find will broaden your understanding of the topic and may even change some of your opinions on it.

CONDUCTING RESEARCH

Begin to research a topic by exploring what you already know. List any words or phrases related to the topic. Once you have your list, you can begin your research. With Internet searches, try to narrow broad terms so your search yields better results (for example, "elementary school curriculum in history" will lead you to more useful sources than simply "school" or "history"). You may want to expand your list later, based on what you discover.

Encyclopedias

An excellent place to get a basic understanding of a topic is in an encyclopedia at home or in a library. Among the most popular general encyclopedias are *The Encyclopedia Americana* and the *World Book Encyclopedia*.* However, there are literally hundreds of encyclopedias, each for a specific field—from anthropology to zoology. An article in one of them can provide a broad picture of the main issues as well as key terms for further research. Make sure, however, that the encyclopedia you consult is current.

The Internet

The Internet has become the primary source of research, especially because it is as close by as your computer or one at your school (or even a public library). The best-known encyclopedia on the Internet is *Wikipedia*. However, some teachers do not allow students to use it because it is not written by experts. Therefore, check with your instructor on his or her policy.

The remaining chapters of this book will provide specific instruction on searching and documenting information from the Internet.

* At the time of this writing, these were still being published in bound book editions, but new editions may move to the Internet.

TRY IT OUT! **Research immigration trends on the Internet and use your findings to write a summary. Follow the instructions.**

1. On an Internet search engine, type in "Immigration from" and add the name of the country in which your parents or ancestors were born. You should find many resources.
2. Select one and find a section that interests you.
3. Then write a one-paragraph summary of the section, beginning by identifying the source, such as "According to *Wikipedia*, . . ." or "James Smith writes in 'Guatemala: Economic Migrants Replace Political Refugees' . . ."
4. Include a quotation if it is appropriate.

QUOTING MATERIAL FROM OUTSIDE SOURCES

As you have seen in the models, an essay gains strength from the backing or support you provide for the claims in topic sentences. Quotations based on your research are a strong source of that support. A **quotation** is a word-for-word, comma-for-comma, exact copy of materials found in outside sources. Quotation marks (" ") signal to your readers that the materials are copied from a book, a magazine, or the Internet. You must identify the source, either prior to or following the quotation. Also after the quotation, you should either explain it or indicate its relationship to the topic idea of the paragraph. Note this pattern in the first example below.

Documenting the sources of quotations, paraphrases, and summaries is a complex issue, based on differing systems used in academic work. Later chapters in this book will show you how to do all this. However, at this point, observe these punctuation and capitalization rules for any quotations you use.

PUNCTUATING QUOTATIONS

Quotations can be punctuated in several ways, depending on the number of sentences quoted, and whether the source of the quote precedes, follows, or breaks up the quotation.

1. A phrase introducing the source appears before the quotation.

   A census in 1841 reported, "Nearly half of the rural population are living in the lowest state." People were crammed inside one-room mud cabins without windows or furniture.

   Note that:

   - the introductory phrase is followed by a comma
   - a period, question mark, or exclamation point[1] goes inside the closing quotation marks
   - the first word is capitalized because the quotation is a full sentence
   - the sentence following the quotation explains, interprets, or adds information to the quotation

[1] In rare cases, question marks or exclamation points go outside the closing quotation marks if they are not part of the quotation, such as: Have you read the chapter in *The American Nation* entitled, "American Society in the Industrial Age"? (The chapter title is quoted.)

2. The first sentence makes a claim that the quotation supports. In this case, the source follows the quotation.

> Abraham Lincoln was regarded as a humble working man. *(Quotation supporting the claim)* "The middle-class country had got a middle-class President at last," wrote the famous author Ralph Waldo Emerson when Abraham Lincoln took office in 1861. *(Relevance to the topic idea)* Indeed, Lincoln greatly advanced the growth of the middle class when he authorized the building of the transcontinental railroad.

Note that a comma replaces a period at the end of the quotation; again, the sentence following the quotation explains, interprets, or adds information to the quotation.

3. Only a few words are quoted and incorporated into a paraphrase, so the punctuation differs again.

> In the 1880s, all the sewers of Baltimore emptied into the Back River Basin, and according to the journalist H. L. Mencken, every summer they smelled like "a billion polecats."

Note that the first word of the quotation is not capitalized; there is no comma before the quoted words.

4. The phrase identifying the source splits the quotation in two parts.

> The founding fathers of the United States were practical men. "The earth belongs to the living," wrote Thomas Jefferson, "not to the dead." Their Constitution and Bill of Rights put those practical concerns into law.

Note that a comma ends the first part of the quotation; a second comma precedes the second part.

5. In a long quotation (about four or more sentences), quotation marks are not even used.

> Jacob A. Riis, a reporter, captured the horror of the crowded conditions of poor immigrants in New York in his classic study of life in the slums, *How the Other Half Lives* (1890):
>
> > The metropolis is to lots of people like a lighted candle to the moth. It attracts them in swarms that come year after year with the vague idea that they can get along here if anywhere; that something is bound to turn up among so many. Nearly all are young men, unsettled in life, many—most of them, perhaps—fresh from good homes, beyond a doubt with honest hopes of getting a start in the city and making a way for themselves. Few of them have much money to waste while looking around, and the cheapness of the lodging offered is an object. Fewer still know anything about the city and its pitfalls.

Note that a colon follows the introduction of the source; the left and right margins of the long quotation are indented; the quotation does not have quotation marks.

PRACTICE 9 Punctuating and Capitalizing Quotations

Add punctuation and capital letters to each quotation.

1. At his Inaugural Address in 1961, President John Fitzgerald Kennedy famously said, "Ask not what your country can do for you. Ask what you can do for your country."
2. During the Civil War, President Abraham Lincoln cautioned it is best not to swap horses while crossing the river
3. A house divided against itself cannot stand Lincoln also said
4. The ballot Lincoln added is much stronger than the bullet
5. Why should there not be a persistent confidence in the ultimate judgment of the people said Lincoln in his First Inaugural Address is there any better or equal hope in this world
6. Mark Twain, the famous American author, once wrote always do right this will gratify some people and astonish the rest

Applying Vocabulary: Using Phrasal Verbs

Before you begin your writing assignment, review the phrasal verbs you learned about on page 70.

PRACTICE 10 Using Phrasal Verbs

Use the phrasal verbs in parentheses to write another sentence. Place the object of the phrasal verb where it fits best.

1. The Great Potato Famine caused terrible suffering. (led up to) It led up to the death of many people.
2. The famers borrowed money to feed their families. (pay back) _____
3. Each year, the crops were destroyed again, but the farmers did not completely lose hope. (wait for) _____
4. Finally, however, they became exceedingly weak and hungry. (gave up) _____

See Appendix D on page 206 for more examples of phrasal verbs.

5. They left Ireland for Canada and the United States. (start over) _____

_____

6. In the United States, they began new lives. (look for) _____

_____

WRITING ASSIGNMENT

Your assignment in this chapter is to write a cause/effect essay about a historical event. Choose a historical event that relates to you, your family, or others—either in another country or in the United States. Write an essay of at least five paragraphs that examines either the causes or the effects of the event. It need not be anything dramatic or political. It could, for example, relate to a festival, a tradition, or a celebration that has a long or interesting history.

Consult one source, either in the library or on the Internet, and use some of the information, including quotations, in your essay.

Develop the body paragraphs with explanations, examples, and even statistics that you find in your research. Do not, however, base your entire essay on what you learn from the source.

Include your personal knowledge of, or experience with, the event, or what you have learned from members of your family. Follow the steps in the writing process.



STEP 1: Explore your topic, audience, and purpose.

- Examine what you know, and add to your knowledge about the subject by consulting one outside source. Take notes on what you find.
- Decide on your purpose. Do you want to inform or entertain your readers.



STEP 2: Prewrite to get ideas.

- Freewrite, brainstorm, or do clustering to explore your ideas.

Writing Tip

Do a cluster diagram to help you generate and organize your paper. For *chain organization*, start at the top of the page and link the circles downward. Then add more circles to the sides to indicate supporting information. See the cluster diagram on page 15 for reference.

For *block organization*, start on the left side of the page and move across to the right. Then add more circles below to indicate supporting information.



STEP 3: Organize your ideas.

- Write a preliminary thesis statement.
- Write an outline of the steps involved, based either on block or chain organization.



STEP 4: Write the first draft.

- Include an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion.
- If you are analyzing the causes of an effect, state the effect in the first paragraph. Also state when and where it happened, and who was involved.
- Likewise, if you are analyzing effects, state the cause of the effects in the first paragraph.



STEP 5: Revise the draft.

- Exchange papers with a partner, and give each other feedback on your papers. Use the Chapter 4 Peer Review on page 231 to guide your feedback.
- Carefully consider your partner's feedback. If you agree with it, revise your paper by marking the changes on the first draft.



STEP 6: Edit and proofread.

- Use the Chapter 4 Writer's Self-Check on page 232 to help you find and correct errors in grammar, mechanics, and sentence structure.



STEP 7: Write a new draft.

- Revise the draft, incorporating all the changes you made earlier.
- Proofread the draft so that it is error free.
- Make sure the draft is legible and follows the format your instructor has provided.
- Hand in the essay to your instructor.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

In this chapter, you learned to:

- ❍ Analyze two cause / effect essays
- ❍ Distinguish between cause and effect
- ❍ Plan an essay using chain or block organization
- ❍ Recognize and use parallel structures to create symmetry
- ❍ Incorporate quotations, statistics, and examples to support claims
- ❍ Write, revise, and edit an essay about a historical event

Which ones can you do well? Mark them ☑

Which ones do you need to practice more? Mark them ☒

EXPANSION



TIMED WRITING

In this expansion, you will write a one-paragraph summary of one of the writing models at the beginning of the chapter. Limit yourself to the main ideas of the model, but *do not include any of your opinions*. Incorporate at least one quotation from the model in your summary. You will have 30 minutes. To complete the expansion, you will need to budget your time accordingly. Follow this procedure.

1. Reread the writing model, underlining the topic sentences of each paragraph. (5 minutes)
2. Write a draft of the paragraph. Be sure to include a title and thesis statement. If possible, combine the ideas of topic sentences, and restate the ideas in your own words. (10 minutes)
3. Revise your paragraph to make sure that a) your ideas are clear and well organized, and b) you have not copied directly from the model. (10 minutes)
4. Check your paragraph for errors. Correct any mistakes. (5 minutes)
5. Hand in your paper to your instructor.



EXAMINING ALTERNATIVES

Write one or two paragraphs in which you suggest at least one possible action that the English government could have done differently to prevent the Irish from starvation during the Potato Famine. Explain how this action might have resulted in a different effect.